SOMIAH GROUP

ADMIN GUIDE

Somasu

Setting up, family members, notifications, releases and troubleshooting

PREPARED BY	Andrew Somiah
PREPARED FOR	Somasu admins
DATE	5 November 2026
VERSION	v10 · app 26 R5

Contents

What admins do 3
How Somasu is put together 3
Free plan limits 4
Setting up Somasu 5
1. Supabase: the database 5
2. Supabase: sign-in settings 5
3. GitHub and Netlify: the website 5
4. Notification keys 6
5. Connect the app 6
Family members 7
Bookings and linked calendars 8
Things to book 8
Linked calendars 8
Notifications behind the scenes 9
Releasing a new version 10
Every release 10
Backups and data 10
Troubleshooting 11
Checklist 11

What admins do

Admins look after Somasu for the family: adding and removing family members, setting up the pieces behind it and putting out new versions. Day to day, admins use Somasu like everyone else; the User guide covers that. This guide covers everything else.

Admin job	How often	Page
Set up Somasu (the database, website and notifications)	Once	5
Add or remove a family member	Now and then	7
Add things to book, help with linked calendars	Now and then	8
Release a new version	When there's a change	10
Check it's healthy	Monthly	11

How Somasu is put together

Somasu is a web app: a website that installs like an app. Three free services run it, Netlify and Supabase are on the SomiahDev@proton.me login, which is for set-up only; the code is on the family's one GitHub account, absomiah-dev, which St Kenelm's also uses. Nobody signs in to Somasu itself with that address.

Service	What it does	Why it's separate
GitHub (absomiah-dev)	Keeps the code and every version of it, in a private repository (a code folder with history).	Shared with St Kenelm's on purpose: GitHub only stores code, so nothing one app does can switch the other off. Private repositories are free and unlimited.
Netlify	Hosts the website and runs three small server programs (functions): linked calendars, notifications and reminders.	Its own account so Somasu never uses up the St Kenelm's credits. If one site runs out, Netlify pauses every site on that account.
Supabase	The database (lists, events, bookings, family) and sign-in (email and password).	A clean account for family apps, separate from school data.

The code lives in My Projects/Somiah-Family-App/01_Site. The web app itself is in public/; the server functions are in netlify/functions/.

Free plan limits

- Netlify: 300 credits a month. Each live release costs 15 credits; test copies (deploy previews) are free. Reminders run every 5 minutes and use a few credits a month.
- Supabase: two free projects per person. Free projects pause after 7 quiet days, but the reminders check every 5 minutes keeps Somasu's awake.
- Emails: people sign in with a password, so Somasu only sends emails for password resets. Supabase's built-in email sends a few an hour and new free projects can't change its wording (June 2026 change). Connecting a free email sender (SMTP, for example Brevo) would lift both limits if it ever matters.

Setting up Somasu

Do these once, in this order. Claude can do the GitHub and Netlify parts with you; the Supabase steps are done in the Supabase dashboard because it's on its own account.

1. Supabase: the database

1. Sign in to Supabase with the SomiahDev login. New project, name it somasu, region London (eu-west-2), set a strong database password and save it in your password manager.
2. Open SQL Editor › New query. Paste the whole of 02_Database-Setup/...Database-setup-v4.sql.
3. Check the box at the top: the first admin's name and the email you'll sign in with (not the SomiahDev address). Click Run. It ends with "Somasu database ready (v4)". It's safe to run again.
4. Go to Project Settings › API (or API Keys). Note the Project URL, the publishable key and the secret key. The secret key never goes in the app, in chat or in an email.

2. Supabase: sign-in settings

Where	Set it to	Why
Authentication › Sign In / Providers › Email	Allow new users to sign up: off. Minimum password length 10; requirements lowercase, uppercase letters and digits	Only people you add can sign in; same password rule as the app checks.
Authentication › URL Configuration	Site URL: the Netlify address (step 3)	So password-reset links open Somasu.
Authentication › Users › Add user	Your own sign-in email and a real password (in your password manager), Auto confirm ticked	Supabase's sign-in list. The script already made you Somasu's first admin on the family list.

3. GitHub and Netlify: the website

1. Create a private repository somasu on the absomiah-dev GitHub account and put the contents of 01_Site in it (Claude can do this).
2. Sign in to Netlify with the SomiahDev login. Add new site › Import from Git › GitHub, allow Netlify to see the absomiah-dev account's somasu repository only, and pick it. Build settings come from netlify.toml; leave them as they are.
3. Site name: somasu (so the address is somasu.netlify.app).

4. Add the environment variables below (Site configuration › Environment variables), then deploy.

Variable	Value
SUPABASE_URL	The Project URL from Supabase
SUPABASE_KEY	The publishable key
SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY	The secret key (server only; lets the functions send notifications and reminders)
VAPID_PUBLIC_KEY / VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY	The notification keys (step 4)
VAPID_SUBJECT	mailto:SomiahDev@proton.me

4. Notification keys

Notifications need a matching pair of keys (VAPID keys: the public half goes in the app, the private half stays on the server). Ask Claude to make a pair, or run npx web-push generate-vapid-keys on a computer with Node installed. Put both in Netlify (step 3) and the public key in config.js.

5. Connect the app

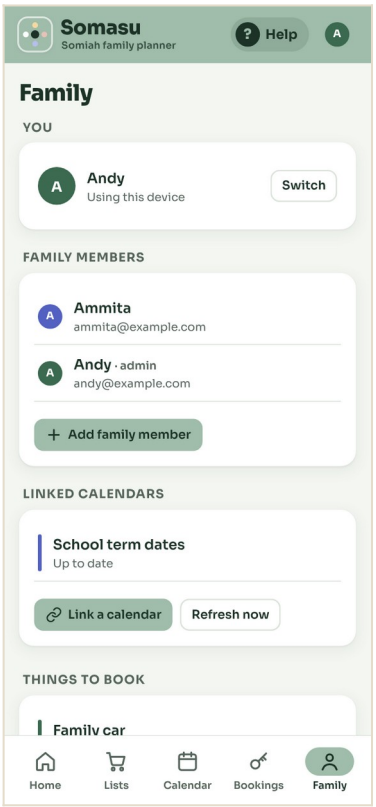
Edit public/config.js and fill in supabaseUrl, supabaseKey (publishable) and vapidPublicKey. Commit the change; Netlify publishes it. Open the site, sign in with your email and password, and check your name shows on Home.

> KEEP SECRETS SECRET
>
> The secret key and the private notification key live only in Netlify's environment variables and your password manager. If one is ever exposed, make a new one in Supabase (or new notification keys) and update Netlify.

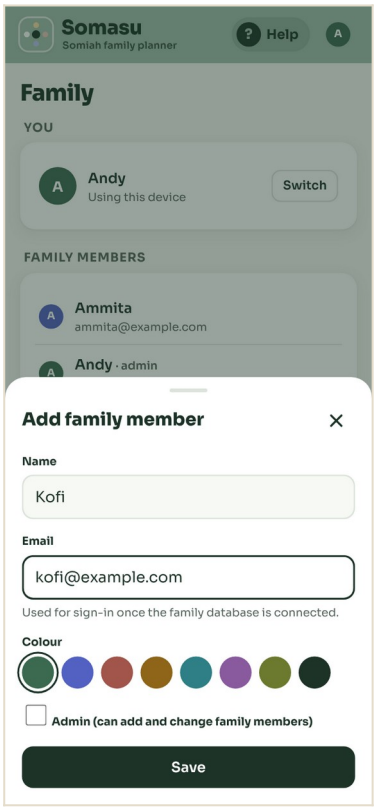
Family members

Adding someone takes two steps, because Supabase looks after sign-in and Somasu looks after who's family.

1. Supabase: Authentication › Users › Add user › Create new user. Their email, a starting password (10+ characters, capital, small letter, number) and tick Auto confirm.
2. Somasu: Family › Add family member. Same email, their name and a colour. Tick Admin only if they should manage the family list.
3. Send them the link and the User guide, and give them the starting password in person or by text (not in the same message as the link). They can change it under Family › Change password.



Family members



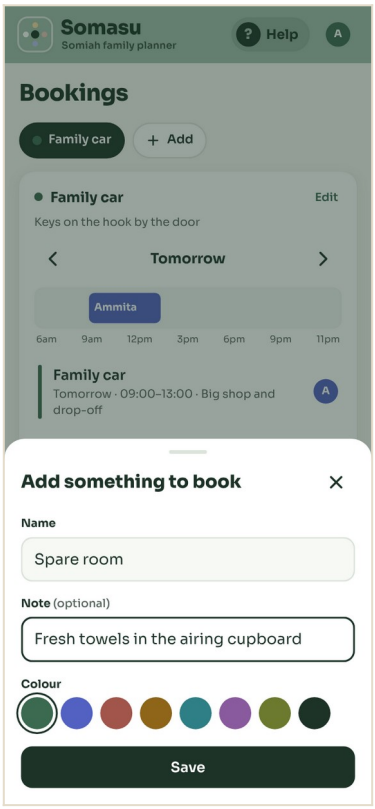
Add a family member

To remove someone, tap them in Family members and choose Remove, then delete them under Supabase › Authentication › Users. Their past items and events stay. Somasu always keeps at least one admin and won't let you remove yourself.

Bookings and linked calendars

Things to book

Anyone can add something to book (Bookings › Add, or Family › Things to book): a name, a note such as where the keys are, and a colour. Deleting one also deletes its bookings, so Somasu asks first. Double bookings are blocked twice: in the app, and again in the database, so two phones booking the same slot at the same second can't both succeed.



Add something to book

Linked calendars

Anyone can link a calendar (User guide, Family and settings). Netlify fetches the calendar for the app, because Google, Outlook and Apple don't let a web page read them directly. Only signed-in family members can use it; it fetches any public https address (so school and club calendars work), refuses private-network and local addresses, and only passes back real calendars. If a calendar shows ⚠️, the link has usually been reset at the source: copy a fresh one and link it again.

Notifications behind the scenes

What happens	Who gets it	Sent by
Items added to a list (gathered up for 45 seconds)	Everyone else with Lists on	notify function, right after the change
Event added, changed or cancelled	The people it's for (or everyone), except whoever made the change	notify function
Booking made, changed or cancelled	Everyone else with Bookings on	notify function
Event reminder	The people it's for, with Reminders on	reminders function, every 5 minutes

Each device that turns notifications on is saved in the push_subscriptions table with its own choices. People can only see their own devices. Devices that stop working (a reset phone, say) are removed automatically the next time something is sent. Sent reminders are logged in reminders_sent so none goes twice, and the log clears itself after 30 days.

Scheduled functions only run on the live site, never on test copies. In Netlify, Logs › Functions › reminders shows a line every 5 minutes, such as "3 with reminders, 0 due, 0 sent".

Releasing a new version

Somasu follows the same version rule as St Kenelm's and Vitro Expenses: the two-digit year plus a release number. Test builds before go-live are R0.1, R0.2…; going live is 26 R1; every release after that adds one. The first release of 2027 is 27 R1.

Every release

1. In public/app.js, change APP_RELEASE and APP_UPDATED, and add the release at the top of RELEASES: one short plain-English sentence per change, under everyone (what the family will notice) and admin (set-up changes).
2. In public/index.html, update the app-version line; in public/sw.js, change the CACHE name to match (this makes phones fetch the new files).
3. If the guides change, update them, export the PDFs into public/guides/ and check the page numbers in the GUIDES list in app.js. If a screen in a video changes, re-record the videos with the script in 07_Videos (they go in public/guides/videos/, listed in VIDEOS in app.js).
4. Push to a test branch first. Netlify builds a free test copy (deploy preview); check it.
5. When it's right, merge to main. That's the live release (15 credits). Open the live site and check the version line and What's new.

> IF THE DATABASE CHANGES
>
> Run the new setup script in Supabase before releasing the app that needs it. The scripts upgrade in place and never delete data.

Backups and data

Anyone can download a backup from Family › Your data. Supabase's free plan doesn't keep automatic backups you can restore, so download one now and then (monthly is plenty) and keep it in OneDrive. The database is in London. Somasu stores names, email addresses, list items, events, bookings and linked calendar links; nothing is shared outside the family.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Check
“Can’t reach the family database”	Supabase dashboard: is the project paused? Restore it. Then check the Netlify reminders log is running (it keeps the project awake).
Someone can sign in but sees “Nearly there”	Their email in Somasu’s Family members must match their Supabase user exactly.
Someone has forgotten their password	They use Forgotten your password? on the sign-in page. If the email doesn’t come, in Supabase › Authentication › Users open their row and send a password recovery, or delete and re-add them with a new starting password (their Somasu data stays).
Nobody gets notifications	Netlify environment variables (secret key, both VAPID keys). Family › Notifications › Send me a test. Netlify › Logs › Functions › notify for errors.
Reminders don’t arrive	Netlify › Logs › Functions › reminders: running every 5 minutes? Is the event’s reminder set, and is it for the right people?
A linked calendar shows ⚠️	The link was reset or the calendar made private at the source. Copy a fresh link and link it again; unlink the old one.
Phones show an old version	Was the CACHE name in sw.js changed? Close and reopen the app.
Netlify says out of credits	Sites are paused until the month resets. Fewer live releases; use free test copies.

Checklist

A quick monthly check, five minutes:

- Open Somasu: lists, calendar and bookings load, and the version line is right.
- Family › Notifications › Send me a test arrives.
- Netlify › Logs › Functions › reminders shows recent runs; credits used this month look normal.
- Supabase project is active (not paused) and the database size is well under the free limit.
- Linked calendars show “Up to date”.
- Download a backup and save it to OneDrive.
- Anyone who’s left the family list removed from both Somasu and Supabase.